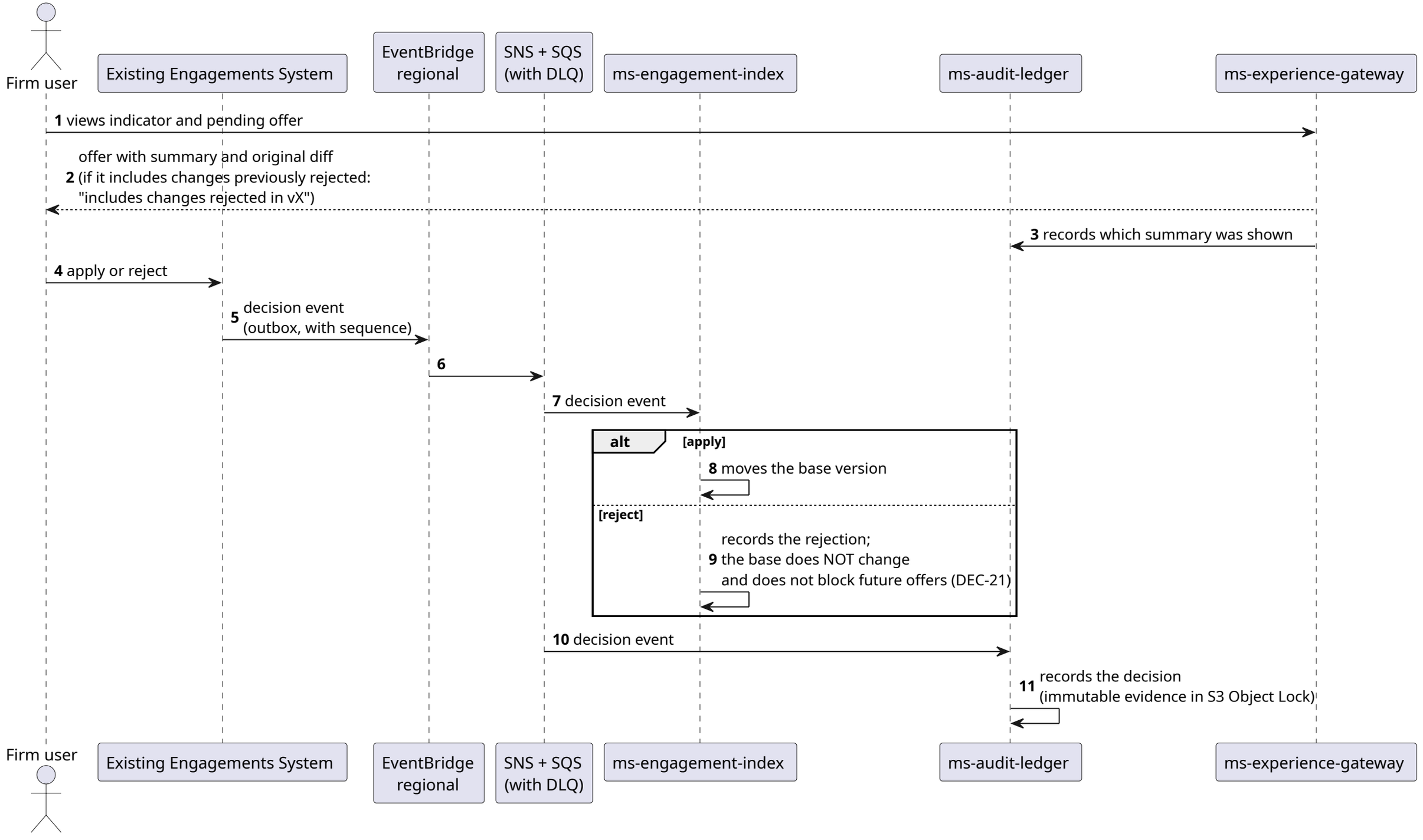2b. Apply or reject decision